

IDS11072
Australian Government Bureau of Meteorology
South Australia

Coastal Waters Forecast for South Australia

Issued at 3:30 pm CST on Wednesday 20 May 2026
for the period until midnight CST Saturday 23 May 2026.

Please be aware

Wind and wave forecasts are averages. Wind gusts can be 40 per cent stronger than the forecast, and stronger still in squalls and thunderstorms. Maximum waves can be twice the forecast height.

Warning Information

For latest warnings go to www.bom.gov.au, subscribe to RSS feeds, call 1300 659 210* or listen for warnings on relevant TV and radio broadcasts.

Weather Situation

A high pressure system over SA will remain dominant as it slowly moves east and into the Tasman Sea on Friday. A cold front move across South Australia over the weekend, followed by another high pressure system.

Far West Coast: WA-SA Border to Fowlers Bay

Forecast for Wednesday 20 May until midnight

Winds: Variable about 10 knots becoming east to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots in the late afternoon. Winds reaching up to 20 knots offshore in the late evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres. Weather: Clear.

Forecast for Thursday 21 May

Winds: North to northeasterly 15 to 20 knots tending east to northeasterly in the afternoon. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing to 1 metre during the afternoon. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres, decreasing to 1.5 metres during the afternoon. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Forecast for Friday 22 May

Winds: Northeasterly 15 to 20 knots turning northerly 15 to 25 knots in the early morning. Seas: 1 to 2 metres, decreasing to 1 metre by early evening. Swell: Southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres inshore, increasing to 1.5 to 2 metres offshore during the afternoon. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 23 May

Winds: Northwest to northeasterly 15 to 20 knots tending northwest to southwesterly during the morning then tending south to southwesterly during the day. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 80% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the morning and afternoon.

Upper West Coast: Fowlers Bay to Elliston

Forecast for Wednesday 20 May until midnight

Winds: Variable about 10 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Mostly clear.

Forecast for Thursday 21 May

Winds: Northeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending northerly in the morning then turning east to northeasterly in the early afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Friday 22 May

Winds: Northeasterly 10 to 15 knots turning northerly 15 to 20 knots before dawn. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres offshore during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 metres, increasing to 1.5 to 2 metres during the afternoon. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 23 May

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots shifting south to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots during the afternoon. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing to 1 metre during the afternoon or evening. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 60% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm.

Lower West Coast: Elliston to Cape Carnot

Forecast for Wednesday 20 May until midnight

Winds: West to northwesterly below 10 knots. Seas: Below 0.5 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Thursday 21 May

Winds: Variable about 10 knots becoming north to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots in the early morning then tending east to northeasterly in the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Forecast for Friday 22 May

Winds: Northeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending northerly 15 to 20 knots before dawn. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres offshore during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 23 May

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots shifting west to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots during the afternoon. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing to 1 metre during the evening. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 60% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the morning.

Central Coast

Forecast for Wednesday 20 May until midnight

Winds: Variable below 10 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Thursday 21 May

Winds: North to northwesterly about 10 knots tending north to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots in the morning. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 22 May

Winds: Northeasterly 15 to 20 knots tending northerly in the early morning. Seas: Below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres in the west. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 23 May

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots shifting west to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots during the evening. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres in the west. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 60% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the morning.

South Central Coast

Forecast for Wednesday 20 May until midnight

Winds: West to southwesterly about 10 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 metres. Weather: Mostly clear.

Forecast for Thursday 21 May

Winds: North to northwesterly about 10 knots increasing to 10 to 15 knots in the morning then tending north to northeasterly in the late afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 22 May

Winds: Northeasterly 10 to 15 knots turning northerly 15 to 20 knots early in the morning. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Becoming cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 23 May

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots turning west to northwesterly 10 to 15 knots during the afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres west of Kangaroo Island. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 60% chance of showers.

Upper South East Coast: Murray Mouth to Cape Jaffa

Forecast for Wednesday 20 May until midnight

Winds: South to southwesterly about 10 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 metres. Weather: Mostly clear.

Forecast for Thursday 21 May

Winds: Variable below 10 knots becoming northeasterly 10 to 15 knots in the late evening. Seas: Below 0.5 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 22 May

Winds: North to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 23 May

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Lower South East Coast: Cape Jaffa to SA-VIC Border

Forecast for Wednesday 20 May until midnight

Winds: Southwesterly 10 to 15 knots decreasing to about 10 knots in the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Thursday 21 May

Winds: West to southwesterly below 10 knots becoming north to northwesterly before dawn. Seas: Below 0.5 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 22 May

Winds: Northerly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 3 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 23 May

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres offshore during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres, decreasing to 2 metres during the afternoon or evening. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Spencer Gulf

Forecast for Wednesday 20 May until midnight

Winds: Variable about 10 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Mostly clear.

Forecast for Thursday 21 May

Winds: Variable about 10 knots becoming east to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots in the early afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 22 May

Winds: North to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Port Neill to Port Victoria. Weather: Becoming cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 23 May

Winds: Northerly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Gulf St Vincent

Forecast for Wednesday 20 May until midnight

Winds: South to southwesterly below 10 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Mostly clear.

Forecast for Thursday 21 May

Winds: Variable about 10 knots becoming easterly 10 to 15 knots in the evening then tending northeasterly in the late evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 22 May

Winds: North to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Becoming cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 23 May

Winds: North to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending north to northwesterly during the day. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Investigator Strait

Forecast for Wednesday 20 May until midnight

Winds: West to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots becoming variable below 10 knots in the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres inshore. Weather: Mostly clear.

Forecast for Thursday 21 May

Winds: Variable below 10 knots becoming northeasterly 10 to 15 knots in the evening. Seas: Below 0.5 metres. Swell: West to southwesterly around 1 metre. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 22 May

Winds: North to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly around 1 metre. Weather: Becoming cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 23 May

Winds: Northeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending northerly during the morning then tending northwesterly during the evening. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly around 1 metre. Weather: Partly cloudy.

The next routine forecast will be issued at 9:30 pm CST Wednesday.

* Calls to 1300 numbers cost around 27.5c incl. GST, higher from mobiles or public phones. Marine forecasts are also available on VHF and HF radio. View the radio schedule on www.bom.gov.au/marine

Check the latest Coastal Waters Forecasts for information on wind, wave and weather conditions for neighbouring coastal zones.
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